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Twitter revealed they are working on an edit button that will allow users to edit their tweets!
<https://digit.in/apr22-31>



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Google is reportedly working on emoji reactions for Google Docs.
<https://digit.in/apr22-32>

SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL

The best TKL you can get your hands on right now

The SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL is part of SteelSeries' new lineup of mechanical gaming keyboards, along with the SteelSeries Apex Pro and the Apex 7. As the name suggests, this is the Tenkeyless variant. Let's jump into the review and see how the SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL fares.

BUILD AND DESIGN

This is the TKL variant of the Apex 7 which means that there's no numpad included. Now, while the lack of a numpad can take some getting used to, there are several benefits to it as well. For starters, TKL keyboards tend to take up less real estate on a desktop. Additionally, there is some benefit to having your hands closer together while gaming, as reducing the distance between your keyboard and mouse has shown to help gamers perform better. There's also the obvious benefit of the keyboard costing less.

The SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL has a very premium look and feel to it. The top plate of the keyboard's body is made out of aircraft grade aluminium. The bottom plate is made out of hard plastic, and comes with multiple grooves for cable management. The Apex 7 TKL uses doubleshot PBT keycaps. On the top right of the keyboard, you've got a clickable scroll wheel, which acts as the volume controls. You've got a single button right under the scroll wheel, which acts as a play pause button. Additionally, both the scroll wheel and the media button can be used to navigate the 128x40 OLED screen that's present just to the left of them. This screen by default displays the SteelSeries logo, but can be customised and used to do a lot more.

You've also got a single USB passthrough behind the left side of the keyboard, illuminated by a white light to help you actually locate the port.

The Apex 7 TKL comes with its own magnetic wrist rest, which has a rub-



bbery coating, so you won't have issues with grip.

FEATURES

Starting with the key switches, the SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL comes with QX2 mechanical RGB switches, which aren't too different from Cherry MX switches; your overall experience shouldn't be too different. The Apex 7 TKL unit that we received for review came with QX2 Reds, which is the linear and quiet switch. In addition to Red, you also have Blue switches which are clicky and tactile, and Brown switches which are tactile and quiet. There's no difference between the three when it comes to actuation force and travel distance.

The keyboard comes with per-key RGB illumination, which can be customised using the companion software, SteelSeries Engine. This is also where you would customise the OLED screen as well. Through SteelSeries Engine, there are a bunch of preset things you can have running on the OLED screen, including system statistics like CPU or RAM usage, temperature and more.

Additionally, without needing to go into the software or settings, things can be tweaked directly on the keyboard itself, which is pretty handy.

PERFORMANCE

We had no complaints when using the SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL. The lack of a numpad can take some getting used to, but the overall experience is quite pleasant, both when it comes to gaming and typing. We found the keys to be responsive and the keyboard to be comfortable, even after long gaming sessions. Typing was also enjoyable on the SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL. We personally prefer red keys for their silence, however, we've found that the QX2 switches are pretty loud despite that. This has more to do with the keycaps bottoming out than the switches itself.

SteelSeries' companion software, SteelSeries Engine, is intuitive and easy to navigate. This is where you'll be able to customise keybindings, macros, lighting, and the OLED settings.



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VERDICT

The SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL is the best TKL keyboard we've used so far, so it shouldn't come as a surprise that it was a runner up for our Zero1 2021 best mechanical keyboard. It's feature-rich and the only thing it's missing is a numpad, but since this is a TKL keyboard, that's the whole point. The only complaint is that it's loud, so if you're in the market for a TKL mechanical keyboard and don't mind it being loud, then go for the SteelSeries Apex 7 TKL.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

TOP MATERIAL: Aircraft Grade Aluminium Alloy Frame | N-KEY ROLLOVER: 84-Key Anti-Ghosting | Dynamic Per Key RGB Illumination | WEIGHT: 771g | DIMENSIONS: 355.44 x 139.26 x 40.44mm | SteelSeries QX2 Mechanical RGB Switch | SWITCH ACTUATION: 2 mm | TOTAL TRAVEL: 4 mm | FORCE: 45cN | LIFETIME: 50 Million Keypresses

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